

Transportation of Minors Policy

Operational Guidelines for Private Vehicle Transportation of Children Under 18

1. Purpose

This policy outlines the procedures and requirements for transporting children under 18 in private vehicles to ensure safety compliance and risk management.

2. Consent Management

2.1 Obtaining Consent

- All parents/guardians must sign current Transportation Consent Forms
- Consent forms must be renewed annually
- Separate consent required for:
 - Regular program transportation
 - Special events/field trips
 - Emergency situations
 - Medical transportation
 - Interstate travel

2.2 Consent Validity

- Maximum duration: 12 months
- System alert for expiring consents
- Consent register maintained
- Emergency contacts updated quarterly
- Parents/guardians must be clearly informed that consent can be withdrawn at any time
- Withdrawal of consent must be recorded immediately and honored without question
- Written acknowledgment of consent withdrawal to be provided to parents/guardians

3. Driver Requirements

3.1 Driver Verification

- Valid Australian driver's license
- Clean driving record check
- Current vehicle insurance
- Working with Children Check/Blue Card
- National Police Check
- Child safety training certification
- First aid certification
- Team leader notification and approval required before any transport
- Transportation schedule and route submitted to team leader minimum 48 hours in advance

3.2 Vehicle Requirements

- Annual vehicle safety inspection
- Age of vehicle not exceeding 10 years
- Child car seats compliant with Australian Standards AS/NZS 1754
- Child car seats must be:
 - Appropriate for child's age, weight and height per Australian law
 - Professionally fitted by an authorized child restraint fitter
 - Less than 10 years old from manufacture date
 - Never used in a previous accident

- Regularly inspected for wear and damage
- Anchor points professionally inspected annually
- First aid kit maintained
- Emergency roadside kit
- Regular maintenance records
- Safety rating of minimum 4 stars (ANCAP rating)

4. Safety Procedures

4.1 Pre-Trip Requirements

- Vehicle safety check
- Weather condition assessment
- Route planning and documentation
- Passenger list confirmation
- Safety equipment verification
- Communication device check

4.2 During Transportation

- Proper seat belt use at all times
- Age-appropriate car seats/boosters
- No front seat passengers under 13
- Adult-to-child ratio maintained
- Emergency contact information accessible
- Mobile phone available for emergencies

5. Documentation

5.1 Required Records

- Transportation logs maintained
- Departure and arrival times recorded
- Driver assignment documentation
- Parent notification records

5.2 Trip Documentation

- Planned route documented
- Estimated travel times
- Rest stops identified
- Alternative routes noted
- Weather conditions recorded
- Vehicle occupancy list

6. Emergency Procedures

6.1 Medical Emergencies

- Emergency contact protocol
- First aid procedures
- Hospital locations identified
- Parent notification process
- Incident documentation
- Medical information accessibility

6.2 Vehicle Emergencies

- Breakdown procedures

- Accident response protocol
- Alternative transportation plan
- Emergency services contact
- Parent communication plan
- Evacuation procedures

7. Staff Responsibilities

7.1 Training Requirements

- Annual safety training
- CPR certification
- Emergency response training
- Child safety seat installation
- Policy updates review

7.2 Compliance

- Policy acknowledgment
- Regular performance review
- Safety procedure adherence
- Documentation compliance
- Incident reporting protocol

8. Review and Update

- Annual policy review
- Staff consultation
- Legislative updates
- Incident response review
- Best practice updates
- Parent feedback incorporation

Document Control

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Owner: Transportation Safety Officer

Related Documents

- Transportation Consent Form
- Route Planning Template